

YARDZEN · VISUAL IDENTITY SYSTEM

Brand Book 2026

A complete visual identity for Yardzen. Most of it's funded by redirecting spend that already goes out every month.

PREPARED FOR

Brian Radics · Yardzen

PREPARED BY

Daniel Pliego · Casa Soda

ENGAGEMENT

Three phases · Sep to Dec 2026

INVESTMENT

\$24,000 USD

CASA SODA

Mexico City · hola@casasoda.com · +52 55 1026 5196

THE ASK

\$24,000, and most of it isn't new spend.

Yardzen already pays for a code design system and ad-hoc marketing work every month.
That's brand work with no brand behind it. During the build it points at the book instead.

LINE	AUGUST	SEPTEMBER	OCT-DEC EACH	Q1
Product	\$9k	\$9k	\$9k	\$9k
Code Design System	\$3k	\$3k	\$1k	\$1k
Marketing asks	\$1k	—	\$1k	\$1k
Brand	—	\$3k	\$7k	\$4k
Yardzen pays	\$13k	\$15k	\$18k	\$15k

The incremental ask is the difference between those bottom numbers. Peak is \$18k a month for three months, against \$13k today. Q1 is direction, not commitment.

Product doesn't pay for this

Product holds at \$9k in every period. A dedicated brand designer joins for this engagement and Said leads brand execution. Casa Soda is adding capacity, not moving your product hours onto a brand book.

WHY NOW

The brand isn't held to the standard the work is.

Your brief says it plainly:

"Erosion of the brand equity due to a lack of adherence to standards: inconsistent font usage, varying tones of voice, lack of brand breakthrough, and brand visuals that lack the quality standards expected."

Yardzen delivers world-class landscape design every week. The brand around it doesn't present at that level, and you have already connected that gap to revenue: **more brand quality means more leads and more design purchases.**

Nobody is ignoring the brand. There's nothing to follow.

Every marketing request today is answered from scratch. Someone picks a typeface, chooses a crop, guesses a colour. Some of it lands on brand. Some of it doesn't. All of it costs a designer.

The standards slip because doing it right is slower than doing it wrong.

That's a system problem, not a discipline problem, and it doesn't improve on its own.

WHAT CHANGES

TODAY	AFTER
Every request starts from zero	The right answer is the fastest one
Marketing needs a designer to stay on brand	Marketing fills a template and stays on brand
A new partner or segment is a new design project	A new partner is a rule already written down
"Is this on brand?" is a matter of opinion	It's a matter of checking
Quality depends on who picked up the ticket	Quality is the floor, not the ceiling

Where the return is

You have already made the revenue argument yourself: **better brand design means more client leads and more design purchases.**

The operating saving is separate and more immediate. Every marketing request currently consumes design time because there's no template to reach for. The eight application templates in Phase 3 are the permanent answer to work that's re-invented every time it's asked for.

THE WORK

Three phases

Phases rather than calendar months, each approved before the next begins.

PHASE	WHAT IT ANSWERS	LANDS
1 · Foundations	The brand. What Yardzen looks like, printed	Sep 29
2 · Copy	The rules. How anyone else uses it	End of Nov
3 · Adaptations	The templates. It applied to real surfaces	December

You see it working on September 29

The first deliverable is a **15–slide brand guide, designed in the new identity and printed.**
Not a logo on a white page. The identity doing its job, in your hands, three weeks from signature.

PHASE 1 · FOUNDATIONS

September 29: the brand, printed.

We don't present a logo on a white page.

The first deliverable is a **15–slide brand guide, designed in the new identity and printed.**
It's the guide and the proof at the same time: the identity doing its actual job, in your hands, not an artifact in isolation.

01	Mission Who Yardzen is for and what it's for.
02	Manifesto What Yardzen believes, said in Yardzen's voice.
03	How we speak Tone of voice, designed from Yardzen's own source material.
04	How we look The identity: marks, colour, type, elements, art direction.
05	How it looks for partners How the brand holds up when somebody else is holding it.

Minimum text per slide, by design. A guide nobody reads is a guide nobody follows. It gets presented September 29, then resolved and specified through October.

This shows you the brand. It doesn't yet tell a stranger how to use it.

That's the difference between Phase 1 and Phase 2, and it's worth being exact about. September hands you the identity, made real. November hands your teams, your contractors and your partners the rules that let them apply it without a designer in the room. They're two different documents doing two different jobs.

YOUR BRIEF

Five objectives, five answers

You set these. Here's what in this proposal answers each one.

- 01

Consistency at scale
A flexible system that adapts across Clients, Contractors and Partners without fragmenting. Answered by the compositional system and the co-branding rules.
- 02

Distinctiveness
Proprietary, recognisable assets. Answered by the graphic elements and the symbol, not by a logo on a page.
- 03

Elevated perception
A premium, design-led identity that makes the promise of a premium landscape credible before anyone reads a word. Answered by the art direction and the visual principles.
- 04

Instill intent
An art direction that associates Yardzen with aspiration, outdoor living and transformation. Answered by the photography and imagery principles.
- 05

Lifestyle brand community
A mark with enough character that people will wear it and identify with it. Answered by the symbol, designed to work on a hat as well as a header.

On depth. Your quality reference is the Topgolf book, which specifies roughly 24 artifacts across 8 formats. This engagement delivers **one complete template for each of 8 surfaces**, plus the system and rules to produce the rest. Additional templates are \$2,500 each.

DELIVERABLES · PHASE 1

Foundations

Everything named here's included in the \$24,000. Anything not named here's a change order.

ITEM	EXACTLY WHAT	COUNT
Brand guide	Designed and printed, in the new identity	15 slides
Moodboards	Style direction and territories, with the argument for each	3 routes
Logo architecture	The full system of marks and how they relate	1 system
Symbol	YZ explored in multiple directions, plus the current Y-in-circle evaluated standalone and beside the wordmark	1 chosen
Lockups	Primary, secondary, vertical · safe areas · minimum sizes · placement · dos and don'ts	3 lockups
Colour system	HEX, RGB, CMYK and Pantone values · usage ratios · the rule for deriving new accents	1 palette
Typography	Arsenal, Geist and one further open-licence face · type scale · lockups · casing rules	3 faces
Graphic elements	The proprietary devices that make a layout recognisably Yardzen at a glance	1 set
Iconography	Style definition plus a core set	1 set
Art direction	How the parts compose into a consistent world	1 system
Compositional system	The grid, headline zones, CTA placement, contextual type usage	1 system

The compositional system is the one to watch. It's what makes the identity a system rather than a style sheet, and it's the reason marketing can eventually self-serve.

DELIVERABLES · PHASE 2

Copy

What are the rules, in writing.

A system nobody can read is a system nobody can follow. This phase is the written document, made so it can be handed to someone and used without a briefing.

Half of it already exists. Your Tone and Voice Guide is done, and it's good: brand voice against human voice, split again by whether someone has paid. It's specific in the way this whole book needs to be. That guide doesn't get rewritten. It gets a face, and the visual rules get written to sit beside it at the same standard.

ITEM	EXACTLY WHAT	COUNT
Visual principles	Photography · AI-generated artwork · the role of humanity · video · angles and cropping	5 sections
Dos and don'ts	Written for a contractor, a partner, or a marketing hire in their first week	Per section
Sub-brand rule	How a future sub-brand takes its colour and lockup from the master brand, without a new design project each time	1 rule
Co-branding rules	How Yardzen sits beside a partner's mark, so partner work stops being negotiated case by case	1 rule

The book ships the rule, not the sub-brands. Resolving named sub-brands into finished identities is separate work, and it's the natural first job of Q1. The rule has to exist before anything can be derived from it.

DELIVERABLES · PHASE 3

Adaptations

What does it look like applied.

One complete, editable, specified template for each named surface. **Eight in total.**

SURFACE	SURFACE
Website	Mailers
Advertising	Partner decks
Social media	Signage
Paid digital media	Apparel and swag

What "one template per surface" means. Each is a complete, specified, editable design: the pattern every future piece on that surface is built from. It isn't every size, format or variant a surface will eventually need. Additional templates are \$2,500 each and are natural Q1 work.

Then the handoff

Brand Guidelines	The complete document, compiled	PDF
Source files	Editable, organised, yours	Figma
Asset packs	Logo and elements exported in the formats each surface needs	SVG · PNG · EPS

HOW IT FITS

Two decisions that save money

We deliberately don't repaint the product yet

An unreleased brand should not be applied to live product UI.

Through the build we align the **structure** of the design tokens to the incoming brand and flag conflicts. We don't restyle the product against a system still under review, because applying it early means doing it twice.

That adoption is what Q1 is for. It lands in the product once it's approved, not while it's being decided.

No custom typefaces

Arsenal is already your display face. Geist already runs in the product. The book disciplines what exists rather than replacing it, and one further open-licence face gets selected in September.

\$0 in licensing.

OWNERSHIP

Two halves, two owners

YARDZEN OWNS · BRAND FOUNDATION	CASA SODA OWNS · VISUAL IDENTITY
Vision and mission	Core visual identity
Target audience	Visual principles
Positioning and comms platform	Applications
Tone of voice	Guidance and governance
Out-of-category references	Compiling the book

Brand Foundation is needed by end of September. The Sep 29 guide designs Yardzen's own words, so mission, manifesto and voice have to exist as source material for it to set them. If Foundation is late, Phase 1 compresses.

One approver

Responsible	Casa Soda
Accountable	Brian Radics
Consulted	Allison, Alicia, Adam
Informed	Alison, Marketing

A visual identity reviewed by committee converges on the least objectionable option, which is the opposite of the distinctiveness the brief asks for. Consultation at every stage. The decision sits in one place.

WORKING TOGETHER

How we work

- 01

A weekly brand review, separate from the product meeting.
Brand decisions need brand deciders in the room, and a review sharing product's agenda is a review that gets postponed. On a fixed schedule that turns into a missed date.
- 02

If product scope grows during the build, it carries to Q1.
It doesn't get absorbed alongside a fixed-date deliverable.
- 03

Two revision rounds per phase.
A round is one consolidated set of feedback from the approver, not opinions arriving separately.

TERMS

Fee	\$24,000 USD, fixed scope
Schedule	\$3k September · \$7k Oct, Nov, Dec
Billing	50% at start of month, 50% on approval
Revisions	2 rounds per phase · additional \$1,500
Extra templates	\$2,500 each
Intellectual property	Transfers to Yardzen on final payment
Product retainer	Separate line, unaffected
If either side stops	30 days' notice · completed phases settled, nothing further owed

What we need from you: Brand Foundation by end of September · one approver · consolidated feedback within five working days · access to the photography library · attendance at the weekly review.

AFTER THE BOOK

A brand book that's delivered and not adopted has changed nothing.

Q1 is where it stops being a document.

ADOPTION The identity implemented in the product. Tokens updated from structure to values, components restyled, the code design system brought onto the approved brand. This is the work deliberately held back during the build.

EXPANSION Sub-brands derived through the rule the book establishes. More templates for the surfaces marketing uses most.

BRAND BOOK 2026

\$24,000 USD

FIRST PRESENTATION

September 29, 2026

The brief asks for a distinctive, design-led brand worthy of the landscape work behind it. That ambition is reachable, because the raw material already exists in the projects Yardzen delivers every week.

What's missing is the system that presents them to one standard.

WHAT HAPPENS NEXT

You	Approve the scope, or tell me what to change
Casa Soda	Territories and moodboards start the same week
Yardzen	Brand Foundation to us by September 30
Together	First presentation September 29

THANK YOU

Daniel Pliego CASA SODA

Mexico City · +52 55 1026 5196 · hola@casasoda.com

See our work at casasoda.com